

However, attitudes are changing now. From mainstream console titles to iPhone games, almost all games need a story or a narrative and have a clear set of emotional shifts, tonal changes, and meaningful moment-to-moment events that generate emotional pay-offs.

What does a Game Writer do?

- ▶ Create concepts, story elements, and pitch documents for mainstream game story and key story moments working closely with game design team.
- ▶ Write and revise game dialogue as declared by gameplay requirements.
- ▶ Accept feedback from fellow writers, design team and development team.
- ▶ Write and revise cinematic scripts for cut-scenes, trailers etc.
- ▶ Create and maintain NPC character information, world back story, and scope for sequels and define emotional experiences of the game.
- ▶ Collaborate with art team to effectively display the character traits etc defined by your story.

Must-have skills for a Game Writer?

- ▶ Good writing skills including ability to write interesting dialogues, narratives etc.
- ▶ Flexible in conducting re-writes and changes in game story as needed by design and development team.
- ▶ Ability to work collaboratively with a team of writers and with a development team and ability to accept feedback and make required changes.
- ▶ Understand techniques to ignite player emotions.
- ▶ Strong research skills and extraordinary attention to detail.
- ▶ Excellent knowledge of writing tools, solutions for content creation such as MS Word, MS Excel, database solutions and script formatting tools.
- ▶ In-depth knowledge of industry trends in interactive storytelling and various emerging story-telling trends like parallel story-telling, multiple-ending stories etc.

Programming

“The concept for PITFALL took less than 10 minutes. The difficult part was sitting at the computer, for over 1,000 hours, and making it happen.”

- David Crane

Video Game Engineering is an intellectually demanding and challenging